

Progettazione di Applicazioni Mobili

Mobile design patterns

Anti-patterns

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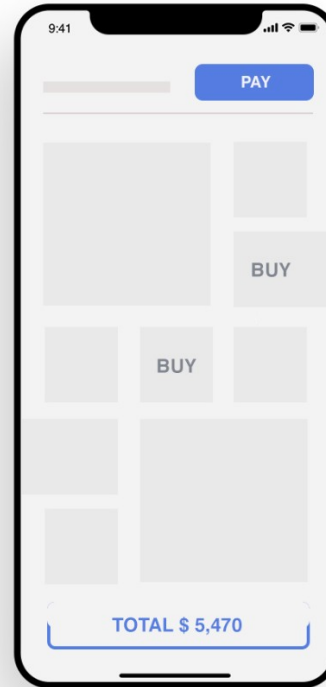


Anti-patterns

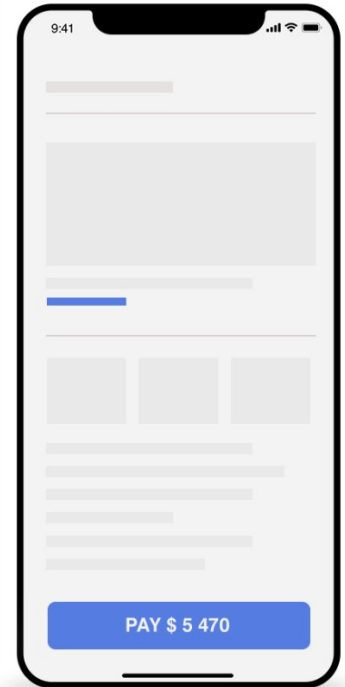
- Anti-patterns are classes of commonly reinvented bad solutions to design problems
- In the following, we will examine several anti-patterns that should be avoided when designing mobile apps
 - Novel notions
 - Needless complexity
 - Metaphor mismatch
 - Idiot boxes
 - Oceans of buttons
 - Square peg, round hole

Novel notions

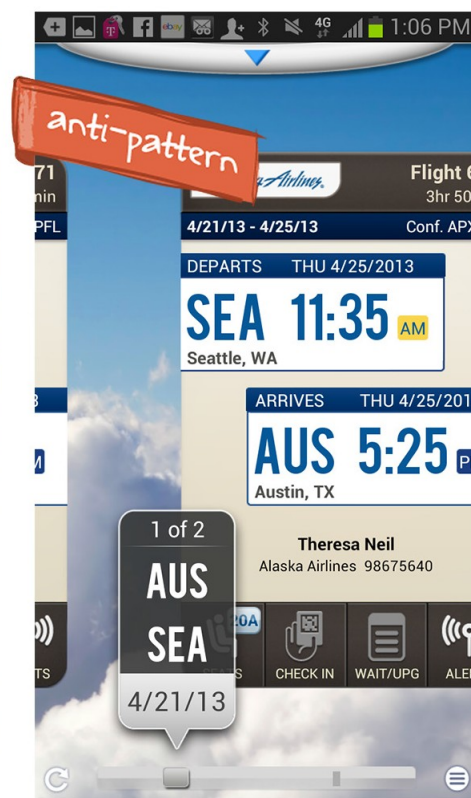
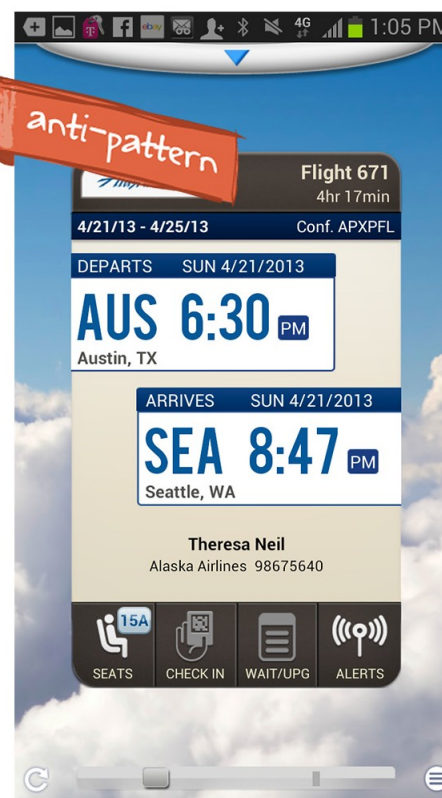
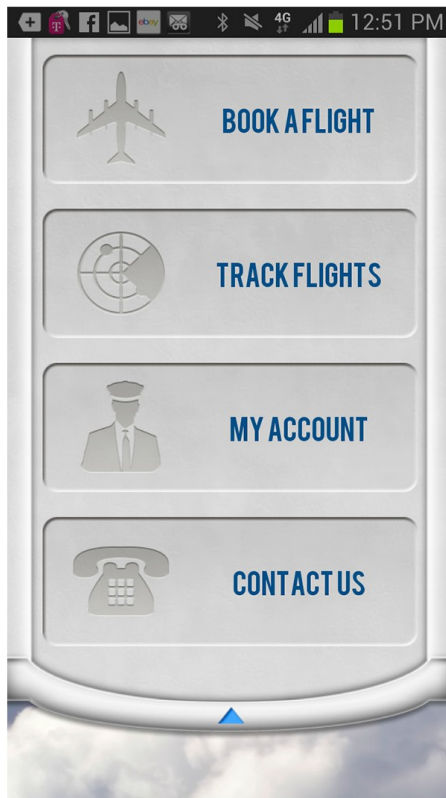
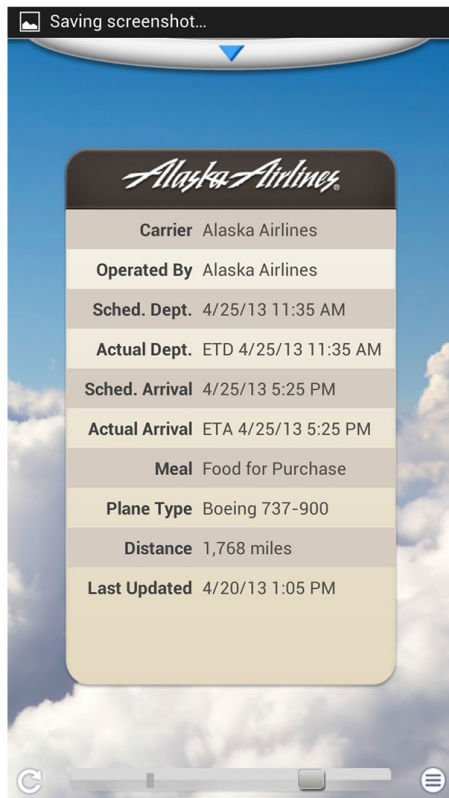
- New designers try out novel design ideas to be edgy, creative, and innovative
- Most of the time, these designs are just bad, hard to understand and harder to use
- Before going for non-standard solutions, test your ideas to get feedback



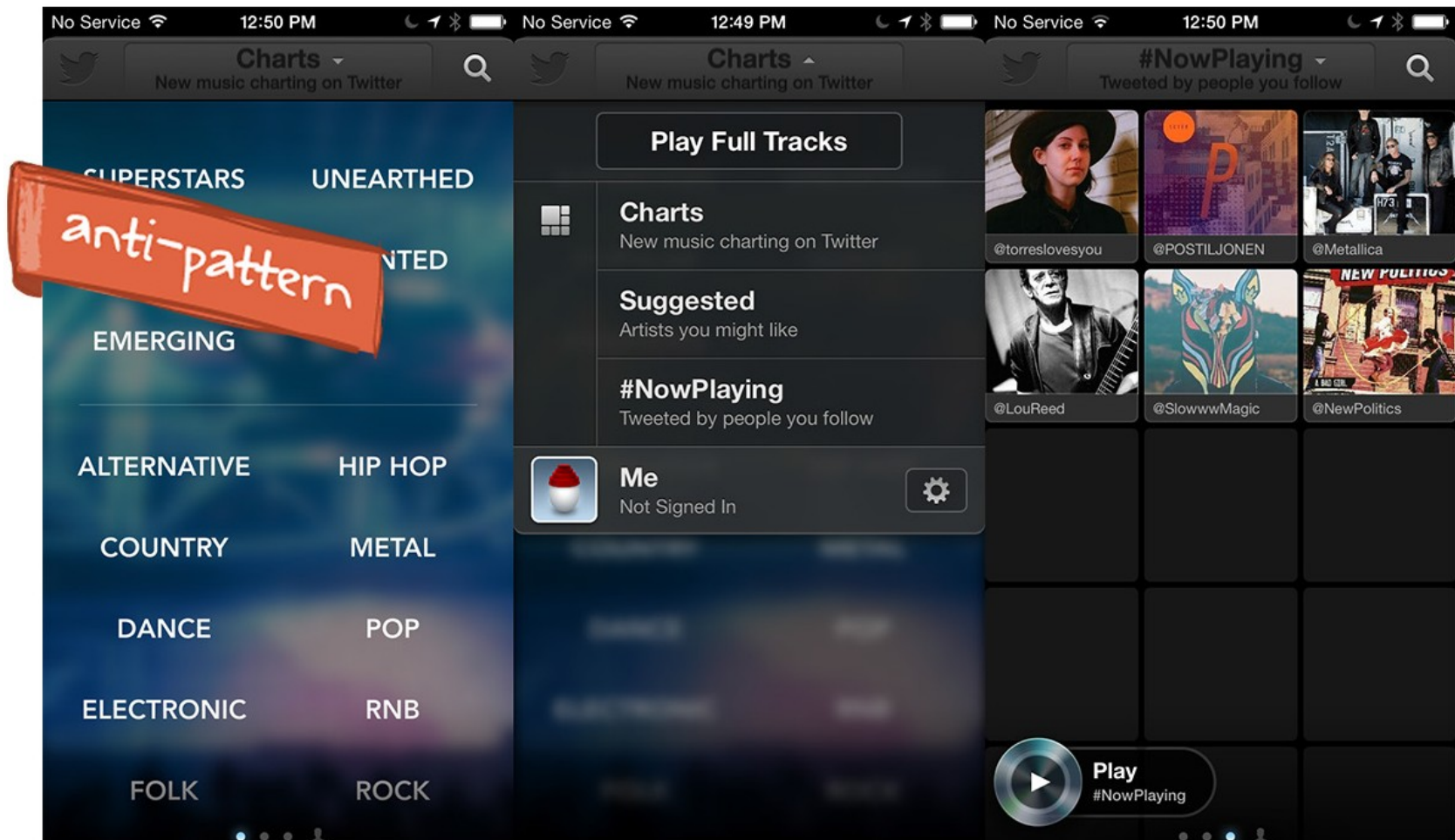
✗
BAD



✓
GOOD



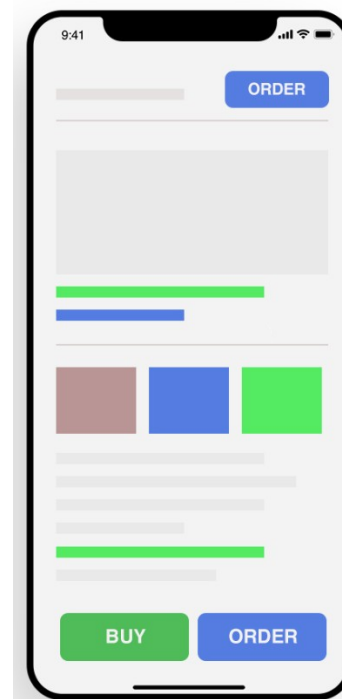
“innovative” menu + navigation through search results with scrollbar



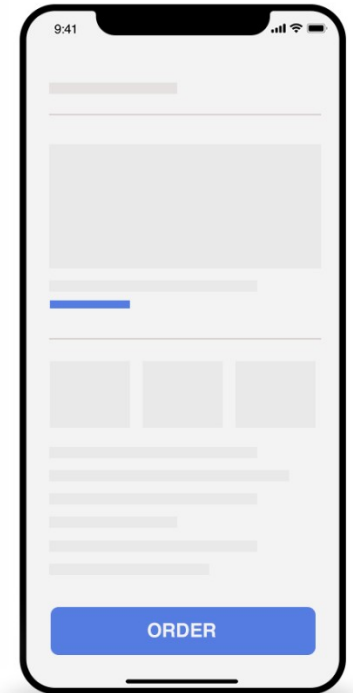
custom control reducing usability: toggle menu tied with paging indicator

Needless complexity

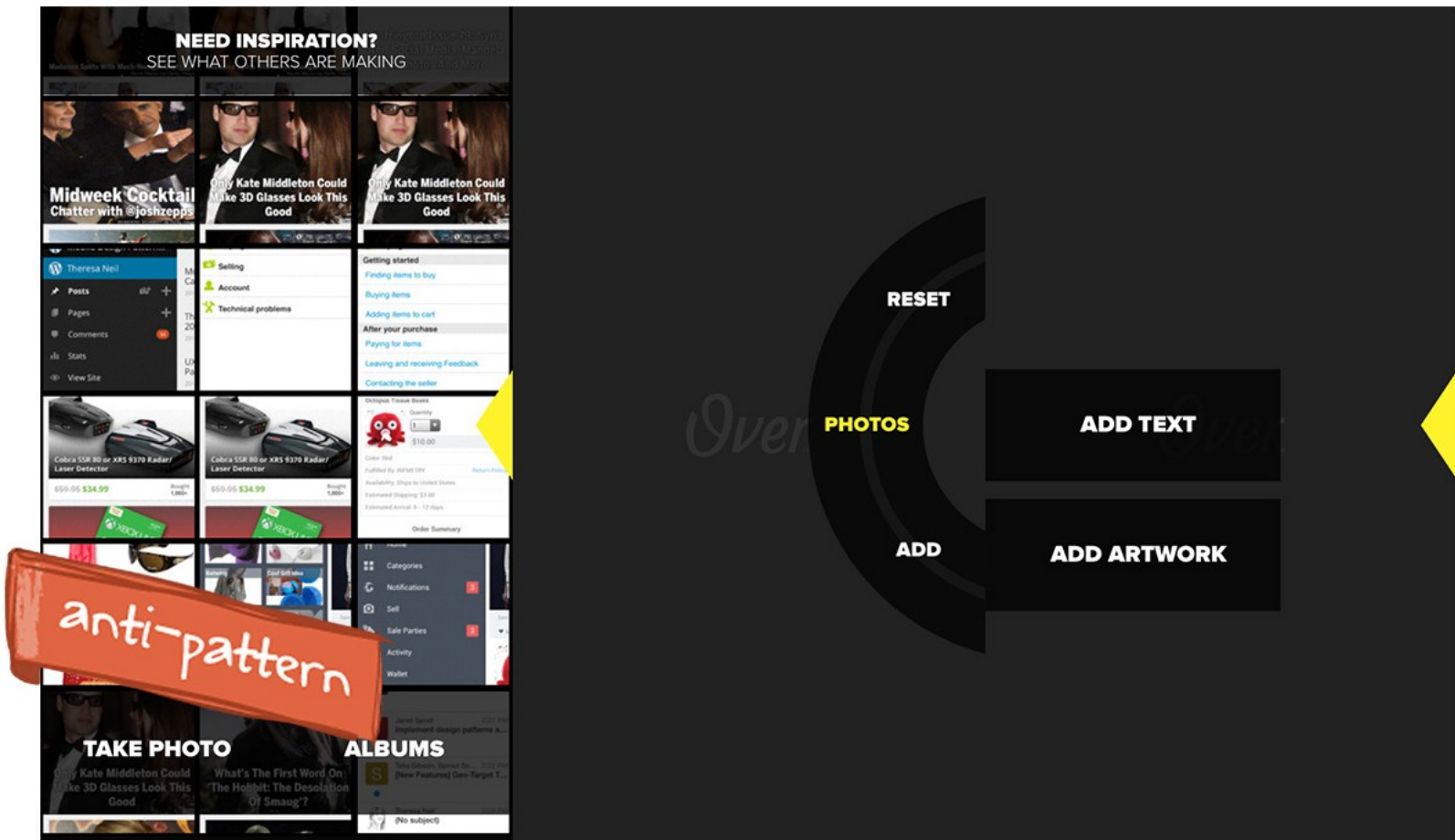
- In their search for novel ideas, designers often introduce needless complexity in their designs, making simple activities difficult or inefficient
- Designers should focus on simplifying interaction with their apps



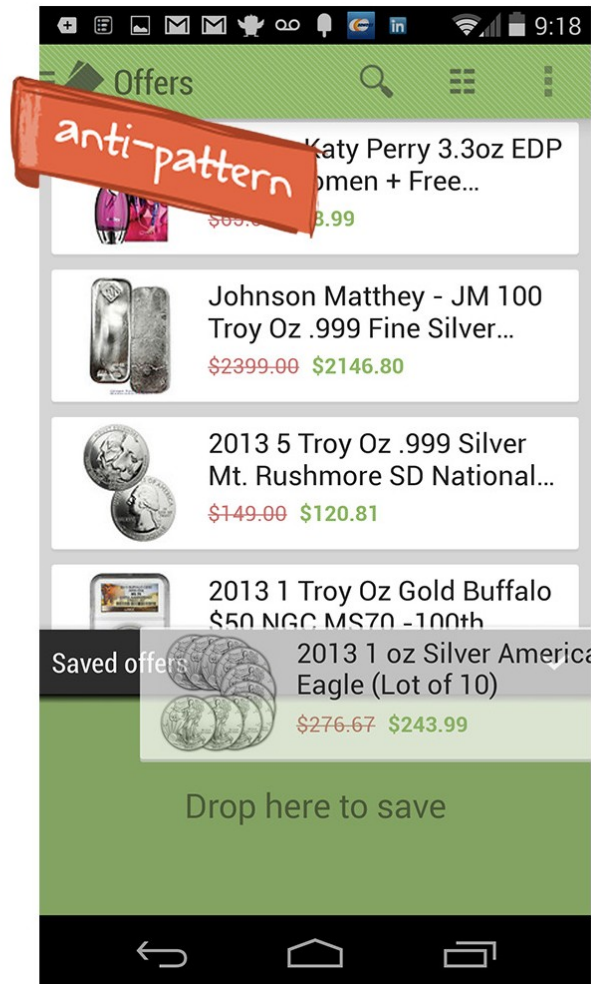
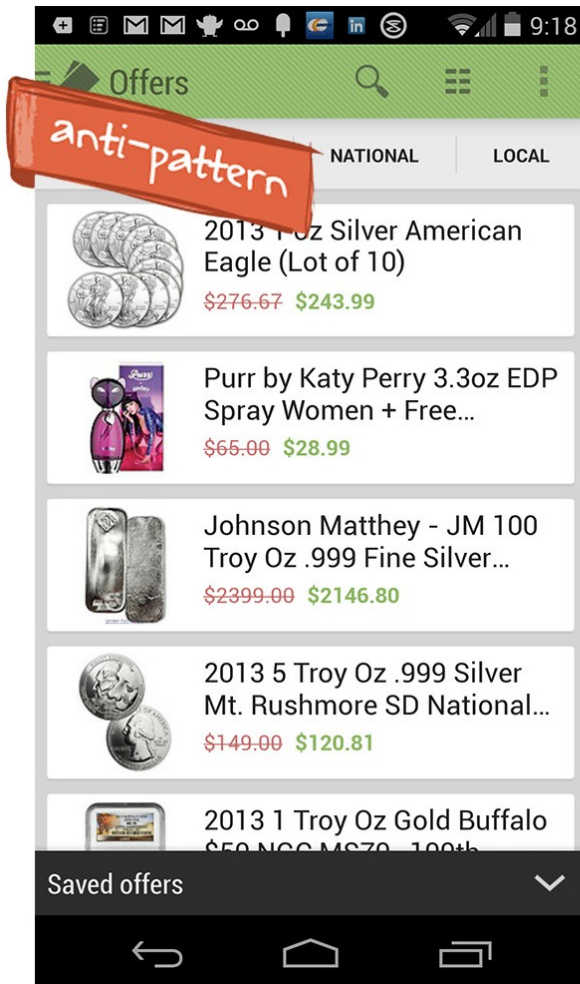
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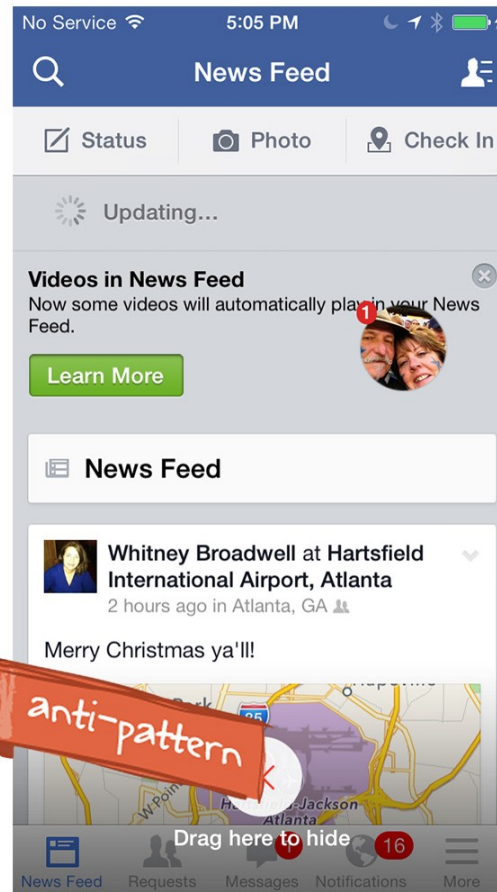
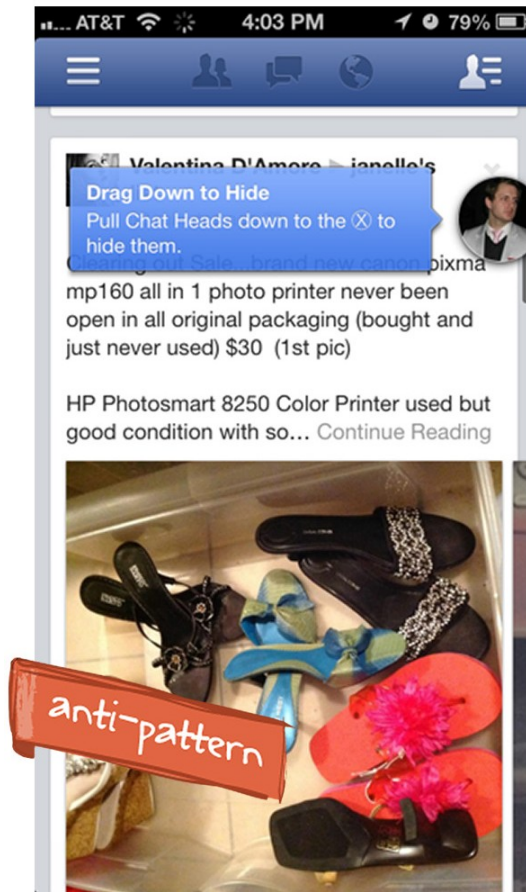
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GOOD



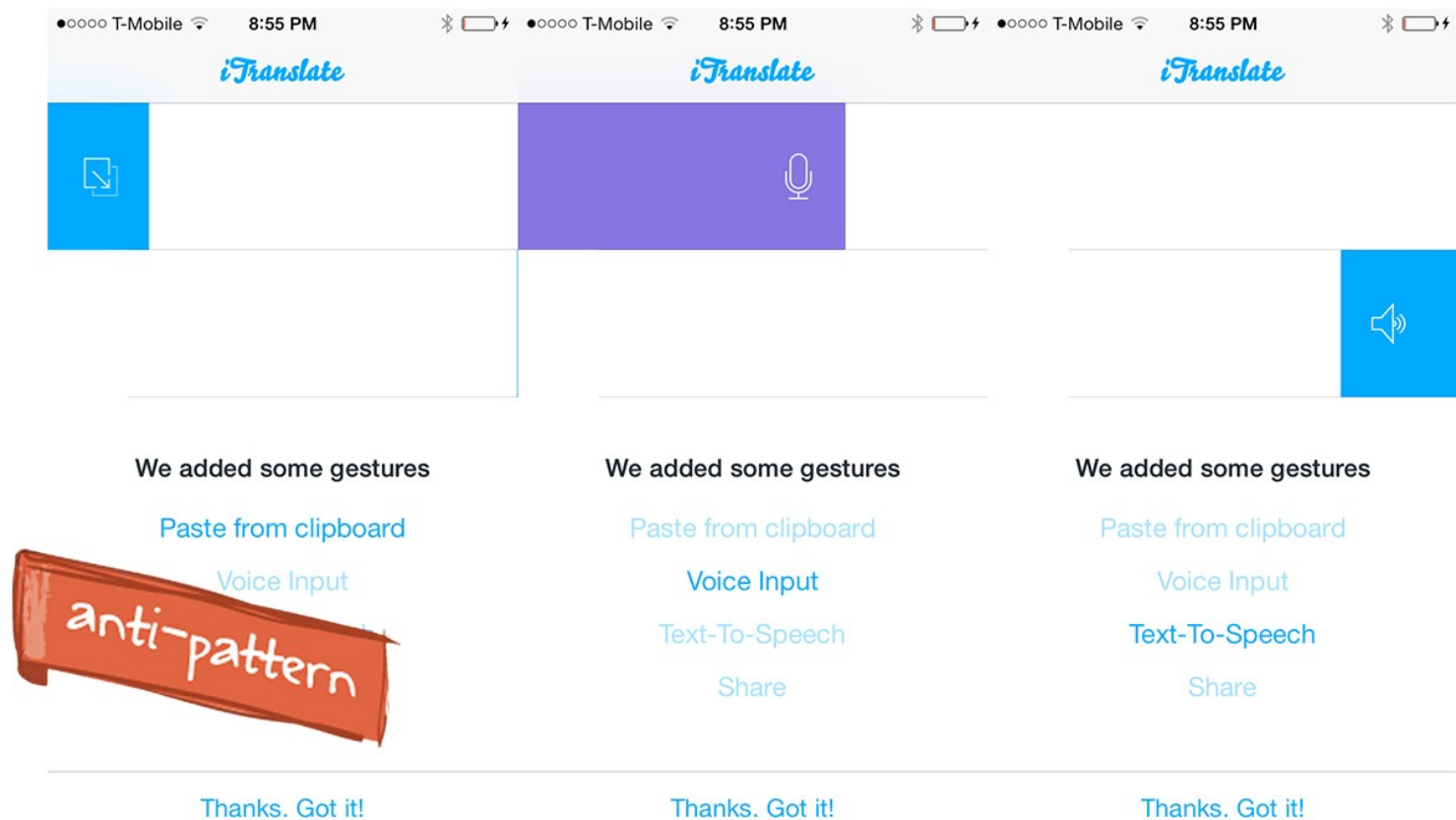
overloaded controls (pie menu combining primary navigation and actions, always changing options)



requiring complex actions to carry out simple activities (long-press drag-and-drop to save)



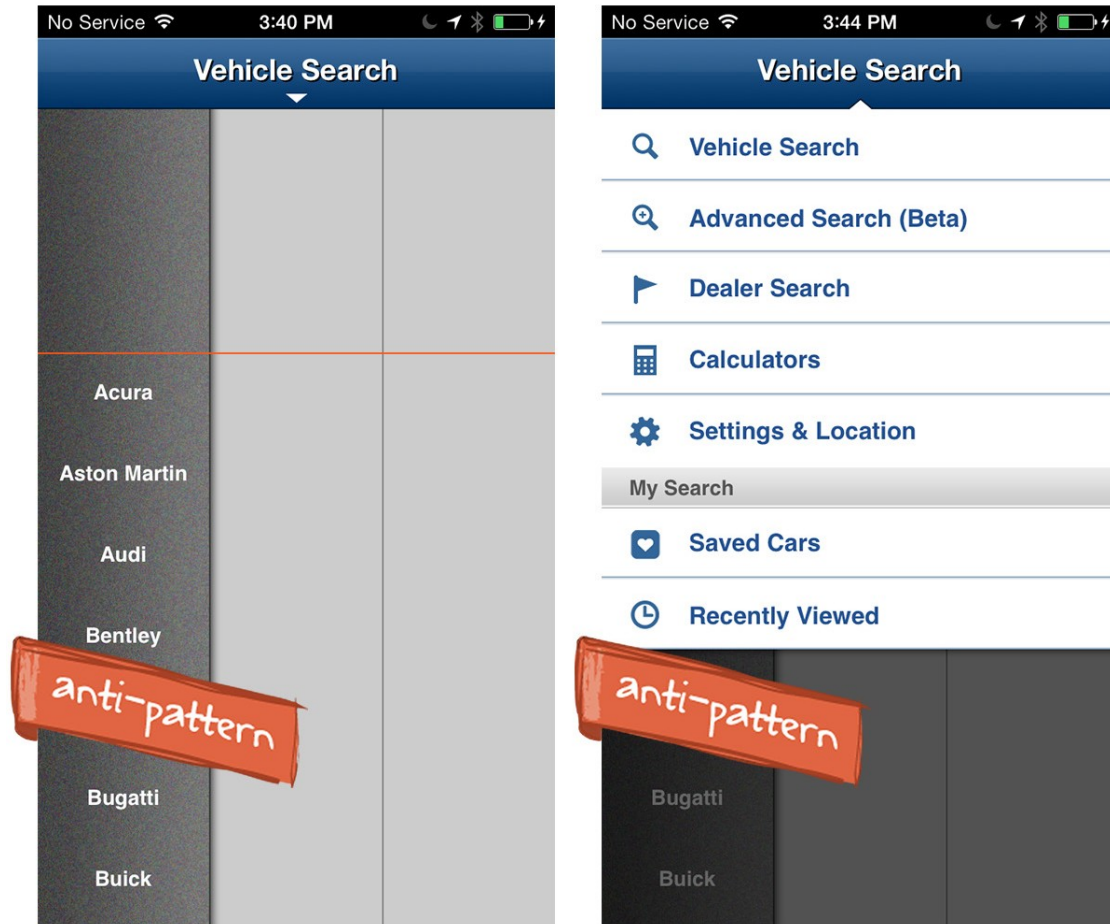
requiring complex actions to carry out simple activities (drag to the bottom to hide chat head)



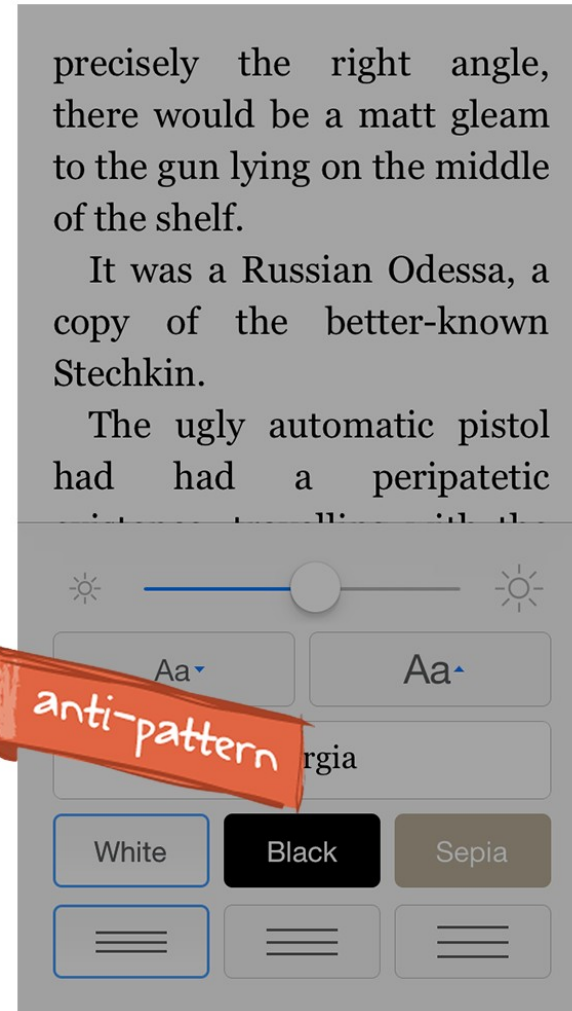
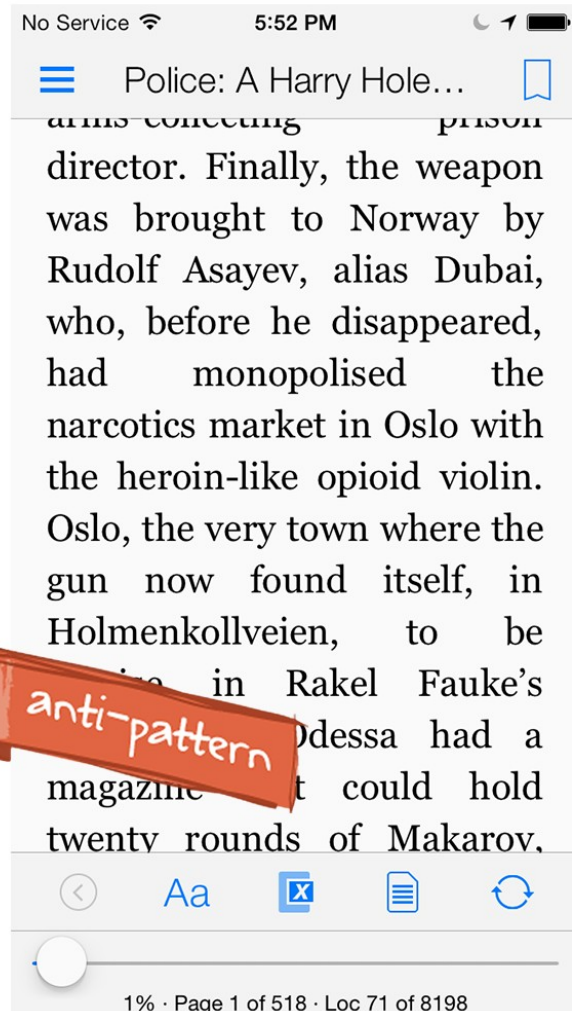
overloaded gestures (short-swipe right to paste from clipboard, long-swipe right to use voice input)

Metaphor mismatch

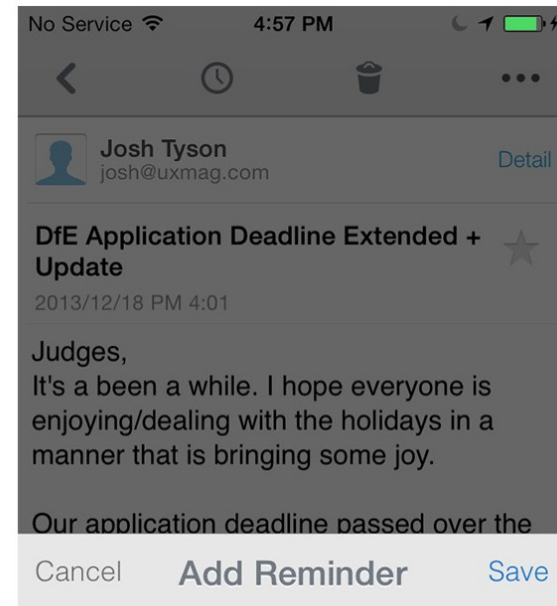
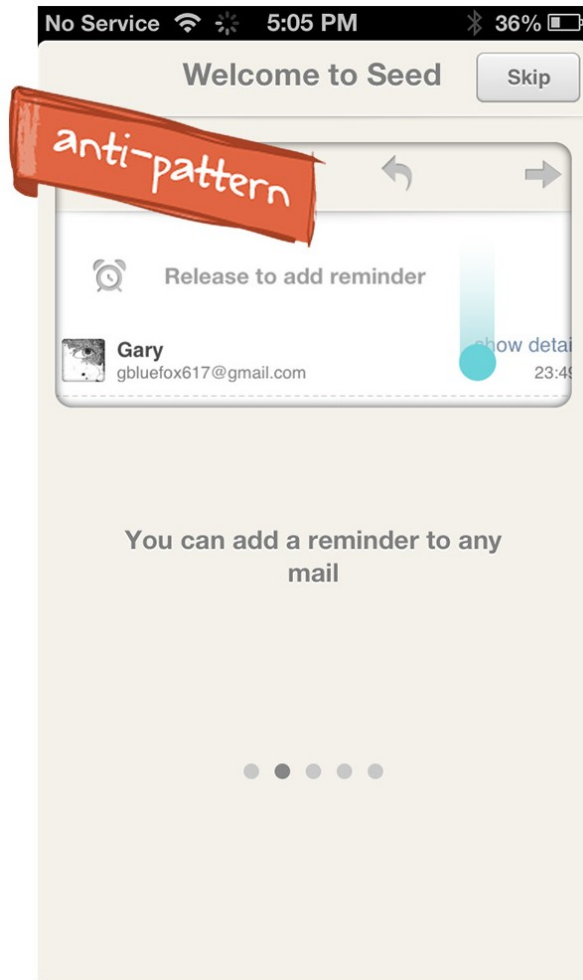
- Metaphors are visual shortcuts that can simplify and enhance an experience
- The metaphor mismatch anti-pattern results from picking the wrong metaphor for an interface
- Metaphor mismatch can occur at a low level, when a control or icon is used inappropriately, or at a high level, where the conceptual model for the application doesn't match the user's mental model



control mismatch (blank home screen is really a search form with a nonstandard menu)

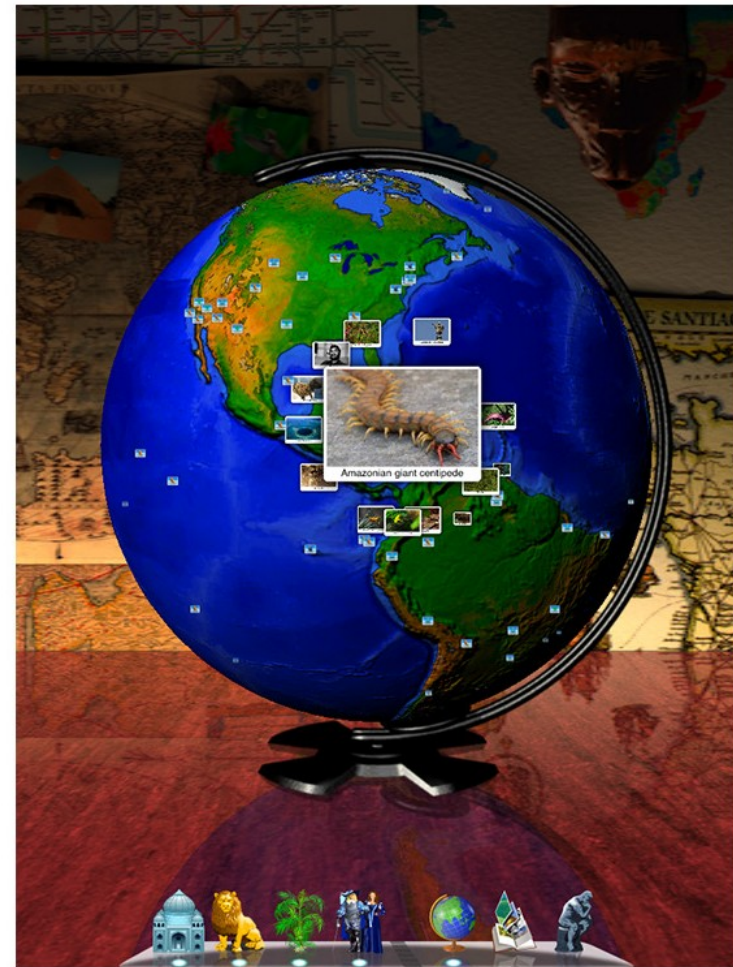


icon mismatch (brightness control hidden under the font properties icon)



Sun Dec 15	2	55	
Mon Dec 16	3	56	
Tue Dec 17	4	57	AM
Today	5	58	PM
Thu Dec 19	6	59	
Fri Dec 20	7	00	
Sat Dec 21	8	01	

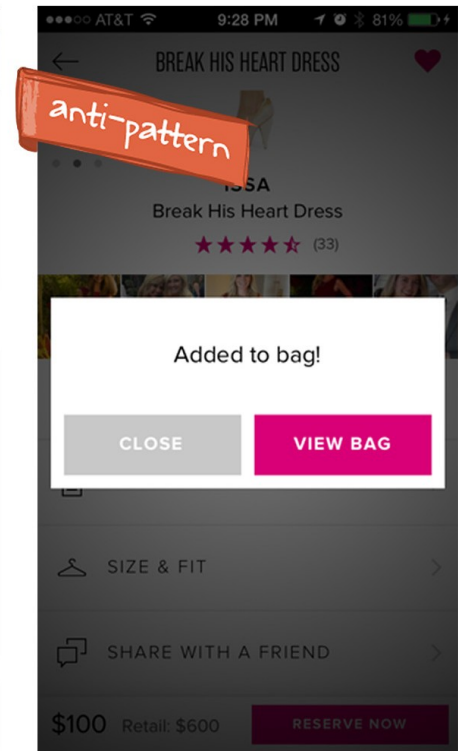
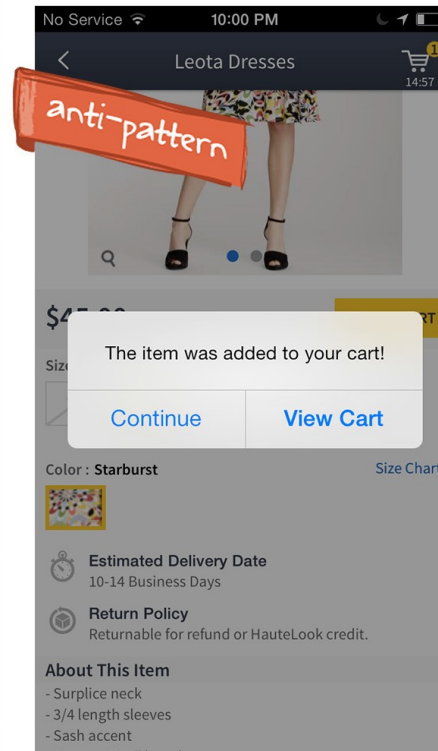
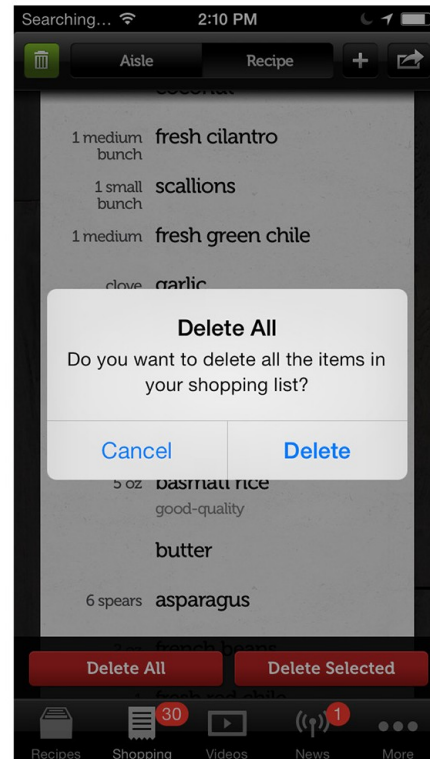
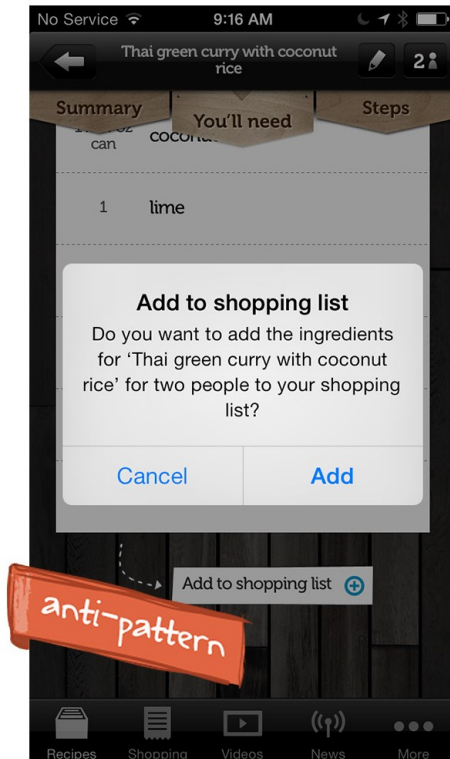
gesture mismatch (pull gesture to add reminder, redesigned version on the right uses reminder icon)



mental model mismatch (left: using a globe for navigating news content uncorrelated to geographic location, right: correlation between content and location)

Idiot boxes

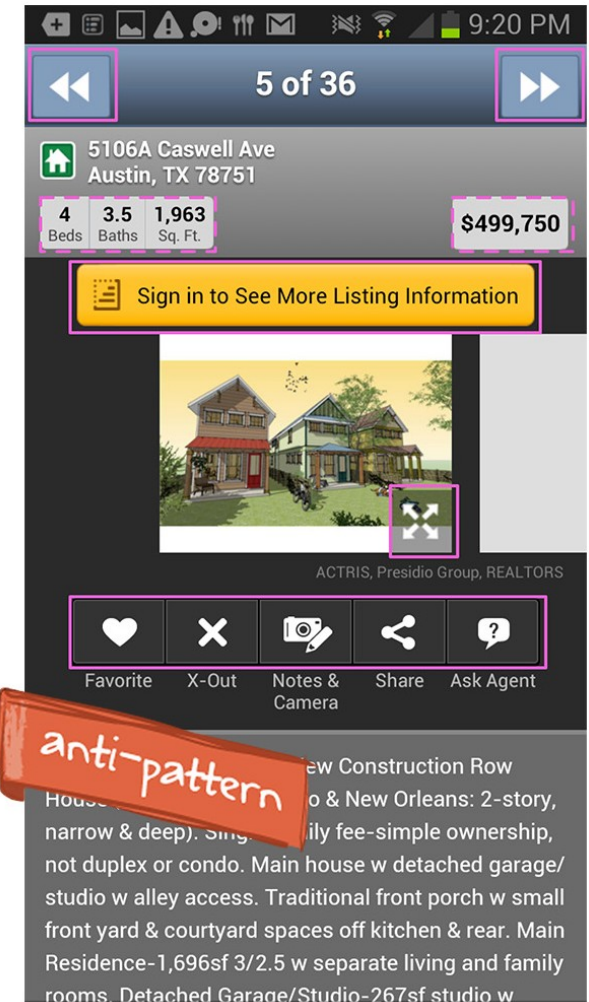
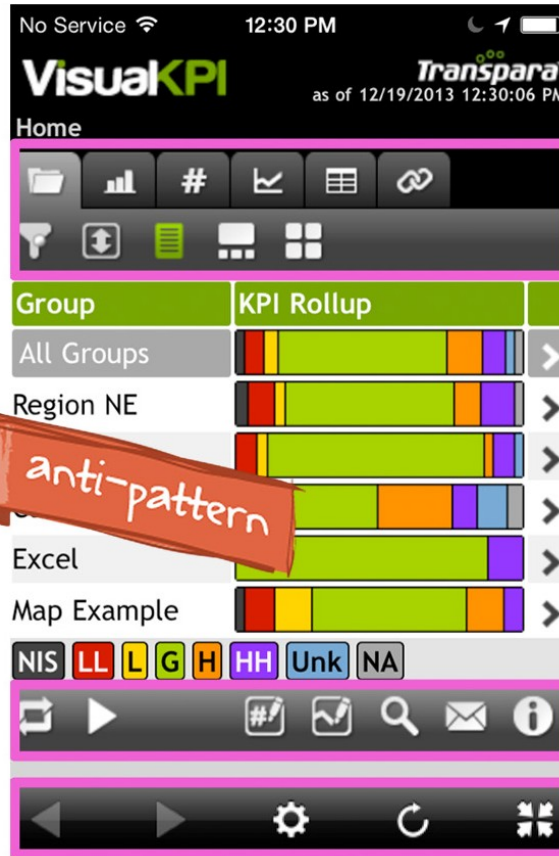
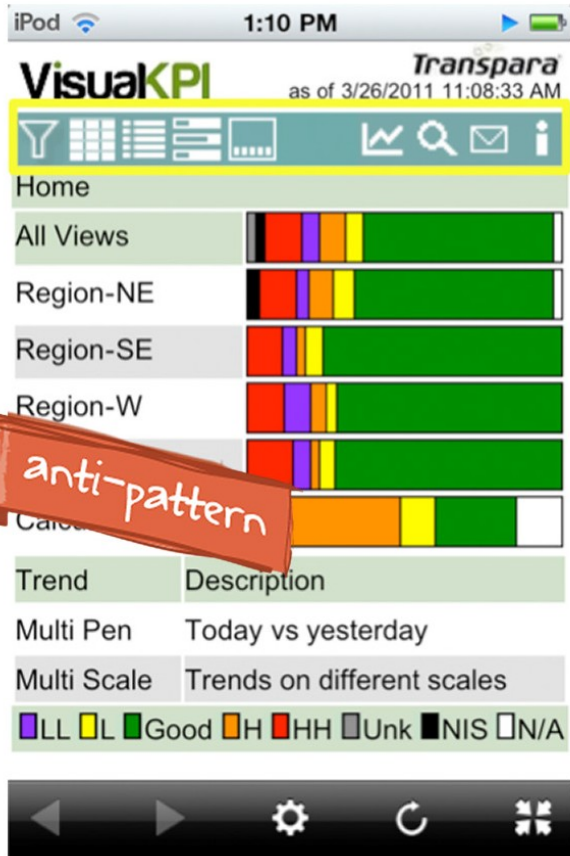
- Idiot boxes are those dialogs that disrupt the flow of use of an application
- Only show a dialog that requires user confirmation when an irreparable action is being taken (like a permanent delete)

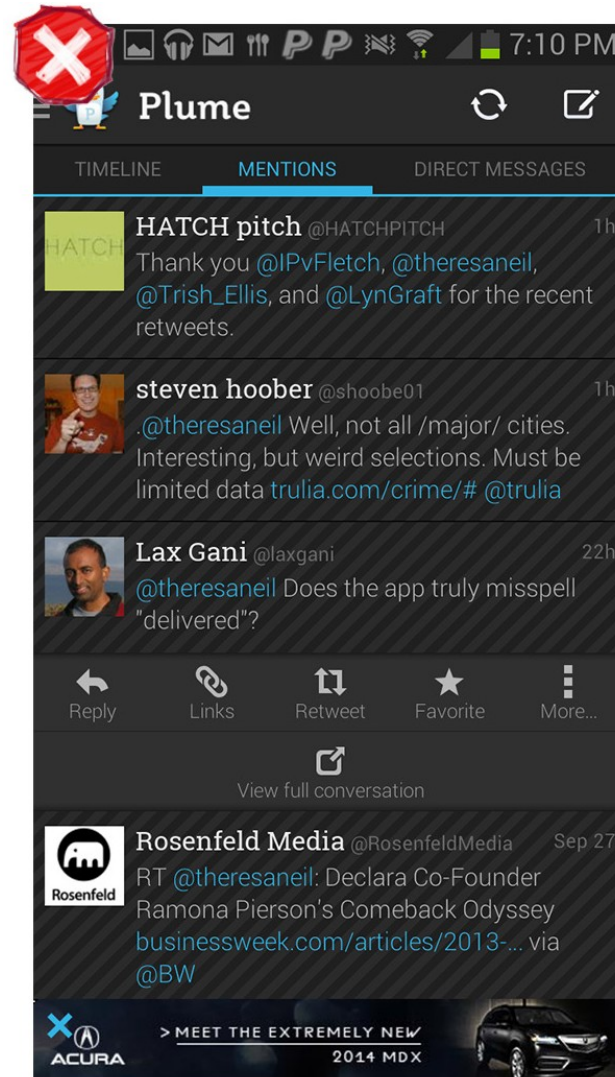
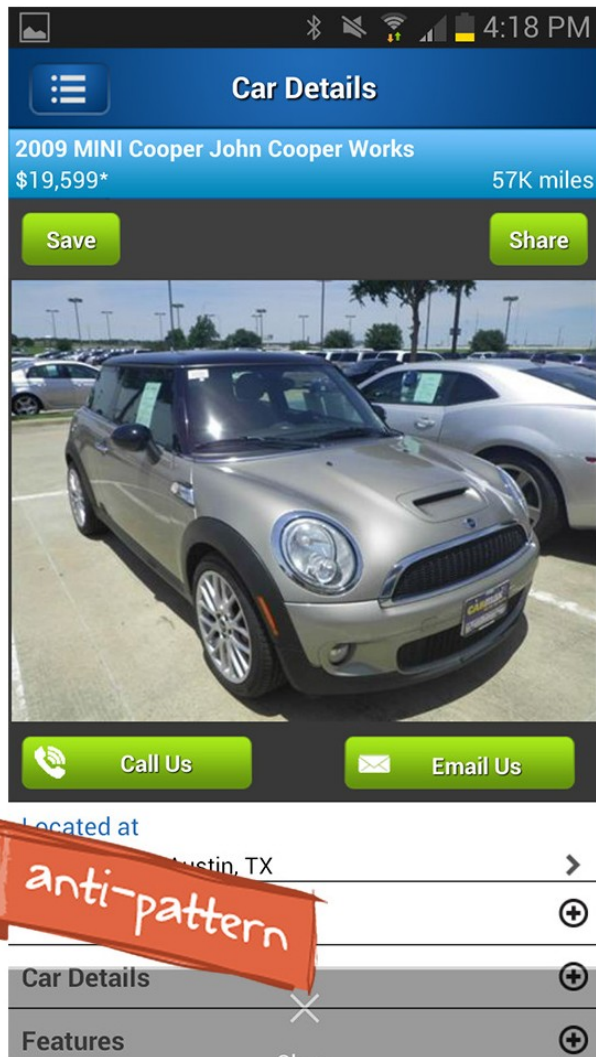


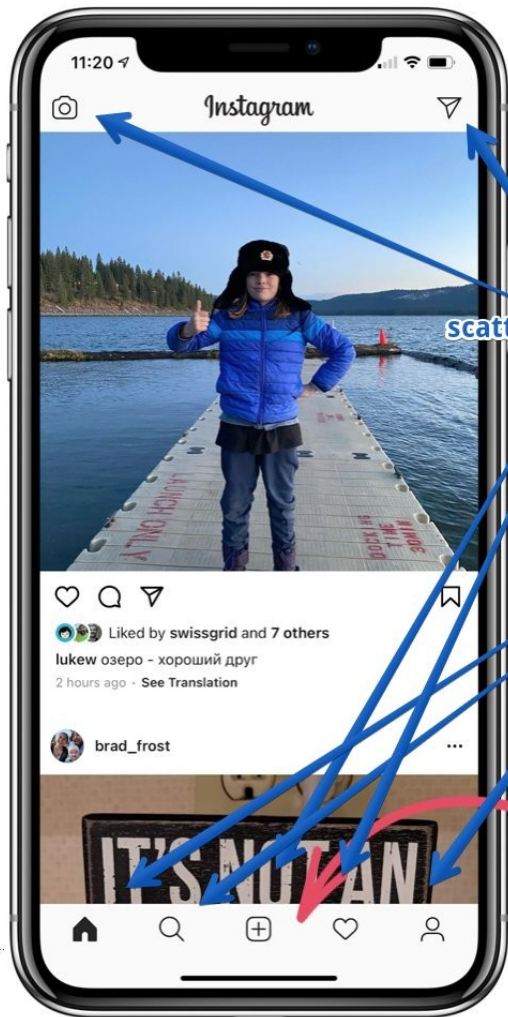
confirming every action is unnecessary (if you need to give feedback, use non-blocking solutions)

Oceans of buttons

- This anti-pattern results from including too many button-like controls on the screen, creating overloaded and confusing interfaces that hide the content
- A variation of this anti-pattern consists in placing buttons in inappropriate positions on a screen
- Use OS-specific controls to provide page-level actions so that buttons stay out of the way until there is a context to use them







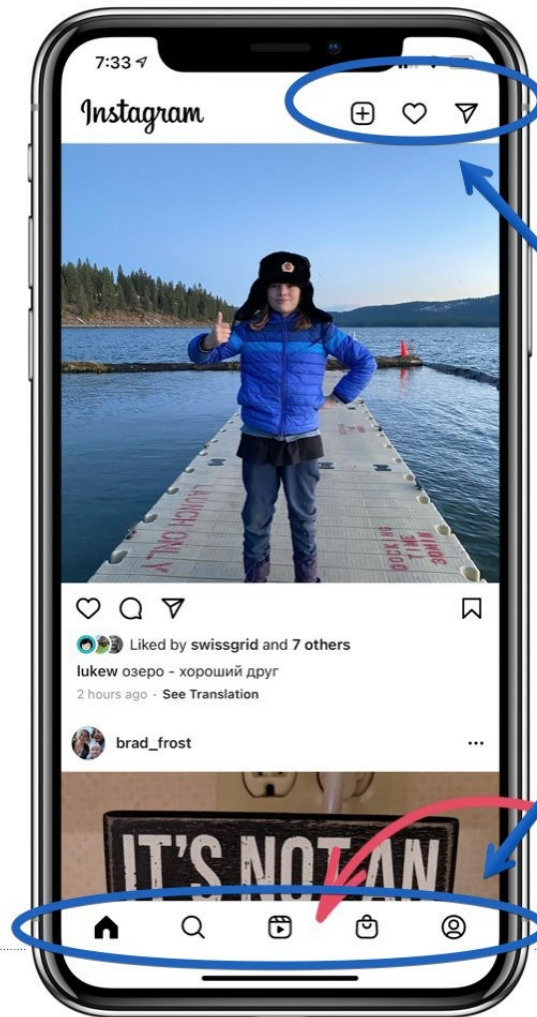
BEFORE

AFTER

scattered creation

mixed consumption

~~user needs: post
& activity~~



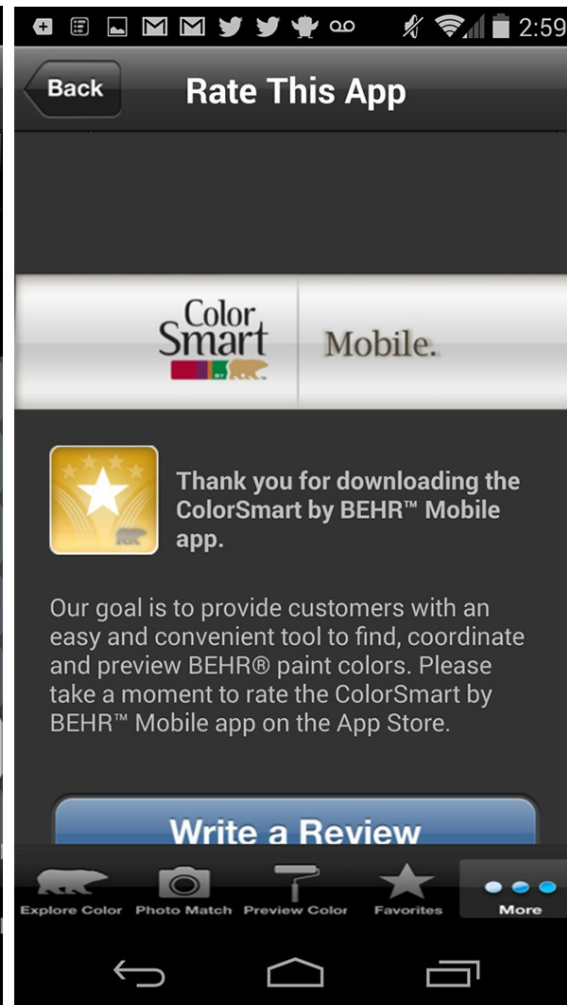
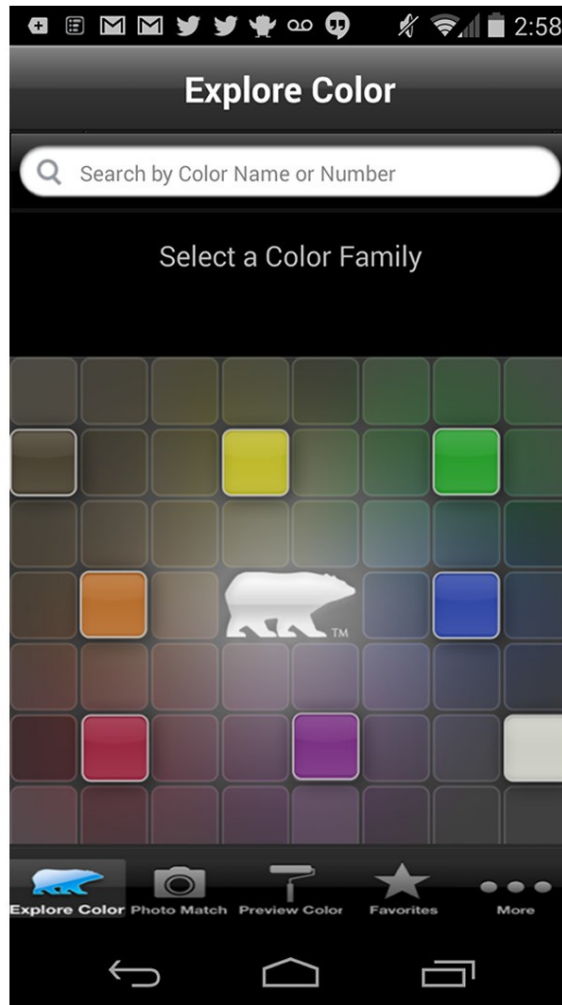
create content

consume content

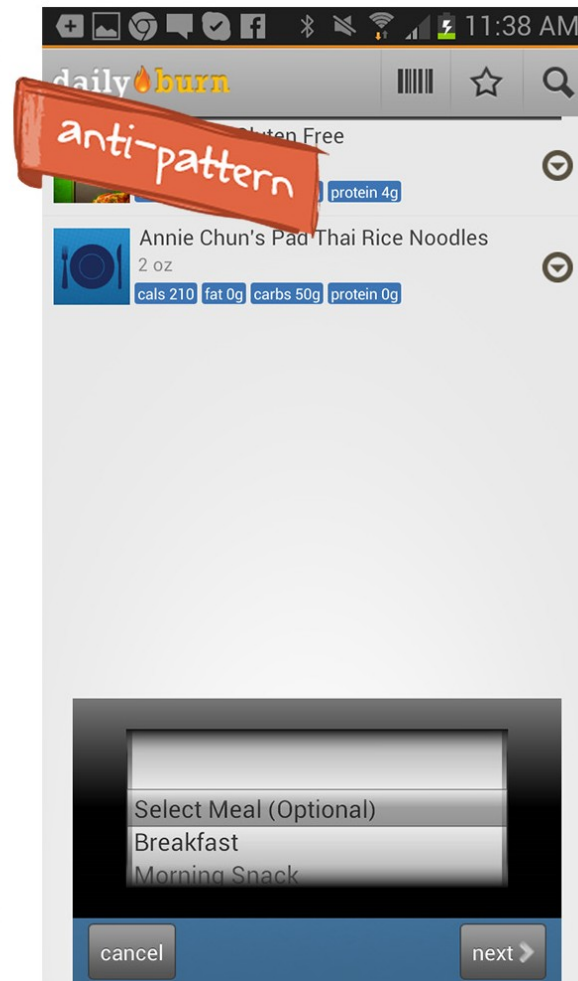
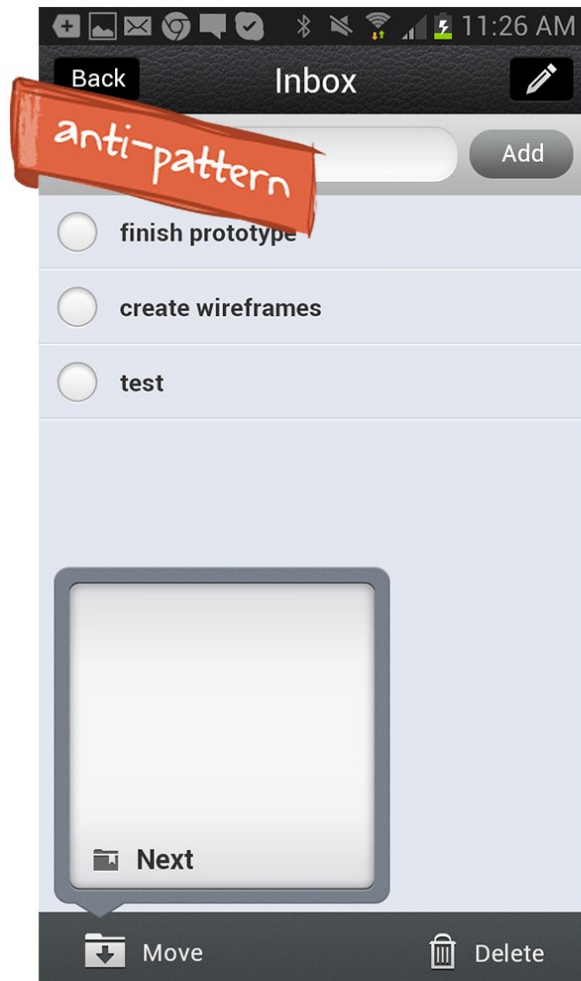
~~company strategy:
videos & shopping~~

Square peg, Round hole

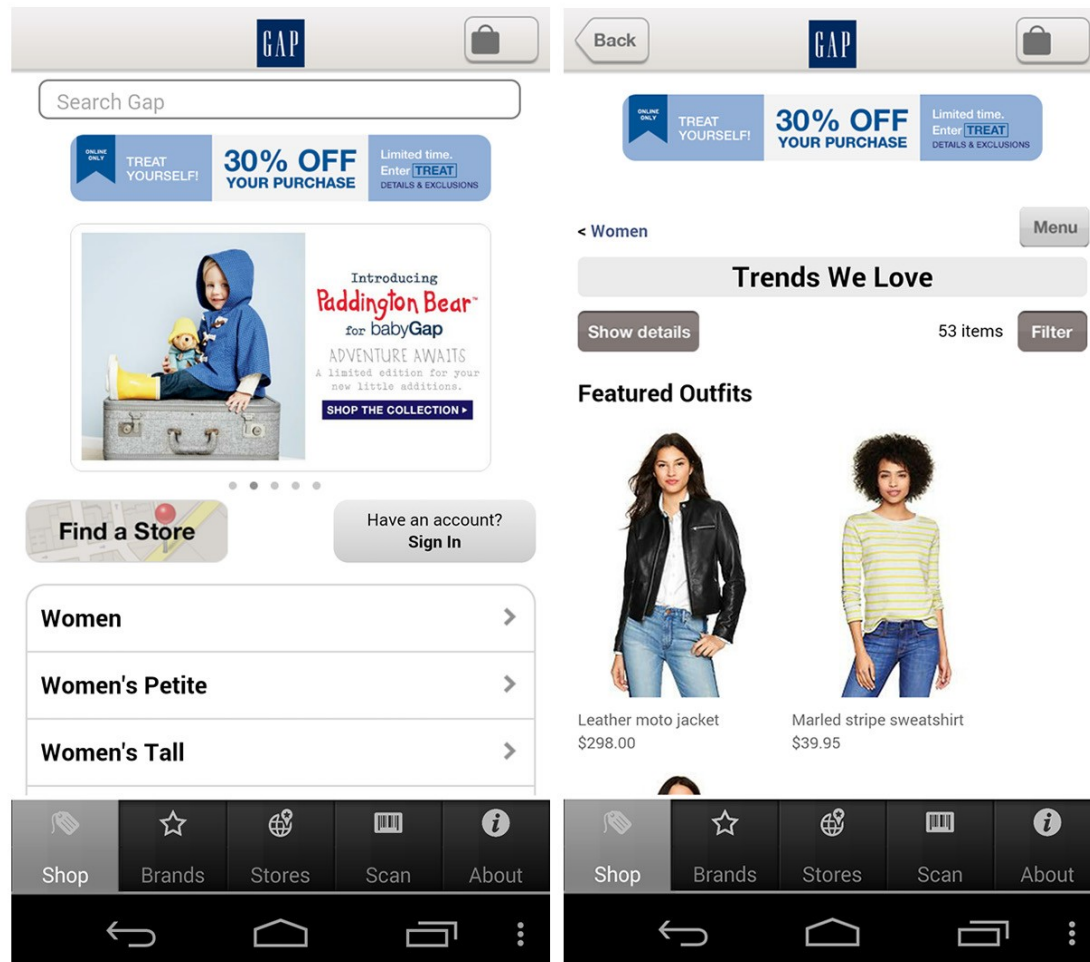
- The Square Peg, Round Hole anti-pattern involves taking a design made for one platform and forcing it into another platform
- Avoid the Square Peg, Round Hole anti-pattern by:
 - Thoroughly reading and understanding the design guidelines for the target OS
 - Using the device you're designing/developing for on a daily basis until you are familiar with the nuances of the platform
 - Designing distinct UIs for each platform, using those platform's conventions



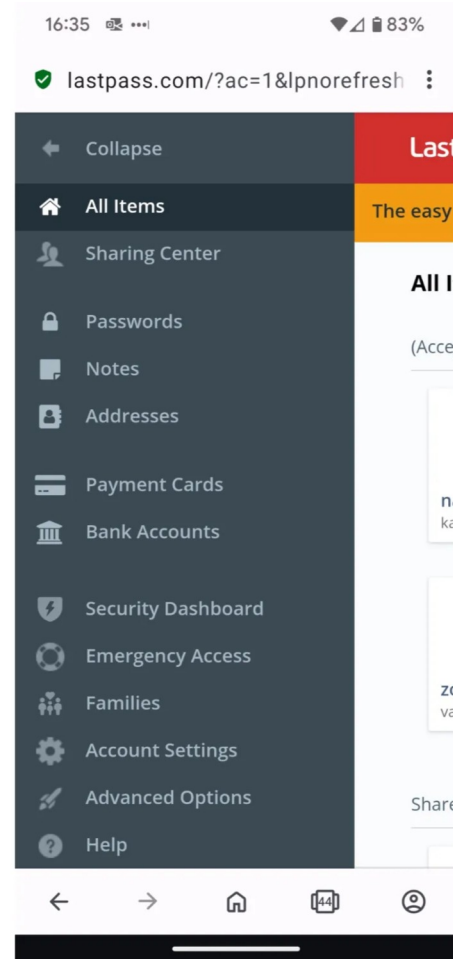
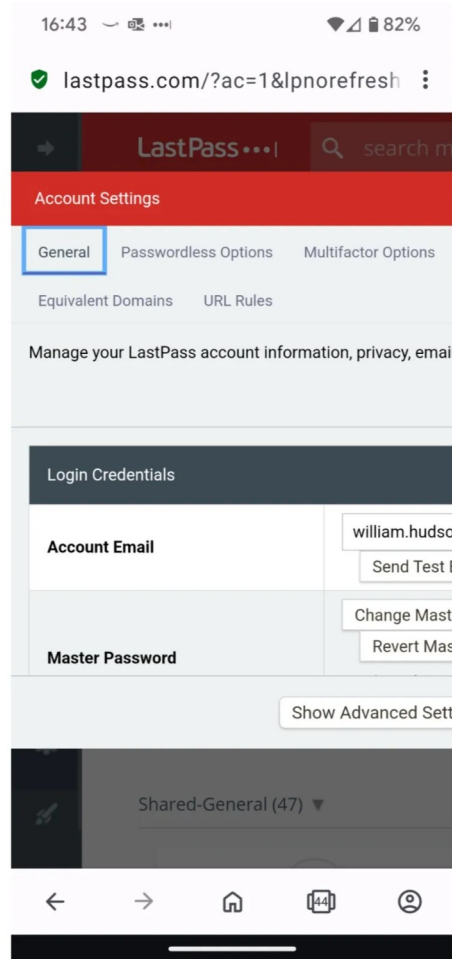
iOS design ported to Android



unexpected iOS-style controls in Android apps



mobile website in a native app wrapper



compressed desktop web interface for the mobile app